

Wayfinder Sourcebook

Wayfinder Corsair Campaign Setting & Rulebook

Chapter 1: Campaign Framework

The World: The Shattered Expanse

Nearly 800 years ago came **The Sundering Tide**. No one knows exactly what happened—whether the gods went to war, an elder civilization awakened something beneath the crust, or the oceans became sentient. The world shattered into tens of thousands of islands. New islands emerge, entire nations drift, and maps are never permanent.

Only about 35% of the world's oceans have reliable charts. The rest is **The Unwritten Sea**.

Core Campaign Blend

This campaign is an exploration sandbox blending “Age of Sail” themes with “High Fantasy” elements: - **The Uncharted Ocean (40%)**: The world is not fully known. Maps are wrong. The primary gameplay loop is Rumor → Expedition → Discovery → Map → Route → Trade → Conflict. - **The Great Magical Trade Network (35%)**: The economic engine. Discoveries matter because new resources (e.g., Moon Coral) create trade opportunities, drawing merchants, pirates, and governments. - **The Pirate Renaissance (20%)**: Pirates are the first people willing to go where governments cannot. The era creates factions—traditional raiders, pirate nobility, independent explorers. - **The Underdark Ocean (15%)**: A massive subterranean ecosystem containing ancient cities, drowned kingdoms, and alien ecosystems like the Aboleth Archives and Drow courts. - **The Lost Civilization Mystery (100% Underlying Engine)**: Why are oceans unexplored? Because someone made them unexplorable. Everything connects back to **The First Captains**.

The First Captains

The original explorers. The first people to bond with ships and spirits. They mastered the connection between Arcane, Psionics, Spirits, and the Ocean. At some point in history, they vanished.

[!NOTE] Level 20 Capstone Quest: Upon reaching level 20, a Wayfinder is offered a legendary quest to “Restore the First Captains.” This world-altering choice asks the player to restore, replace, hide, or release the greatest explorers in history.

The Four Magic Systems

Magic enhances naval warfare rather than replacing it. Ships remain the kings of warfare. 1. **Arcane (The Pact)**: Traditional magic and warlock pacts. Power borrowed from sea devils, leviathans, living storms, or star beings. “I borrowed power from something older than the world.” 2. **Psionics (The Mind)**: Power originating from consciousness itself. Some surface kingdoms fear it; the greatest psionic cities lie beneath the earth. “I discovered that my own consciousness is a weapon.” 3. **Spirit (The Tide)**: Primal sea magic. Not worship, but alignment with the ocean’s natural order. “I learned the hidden laws of the sea itself.” 4. **Deep Magic**: Predates all three. It changes gravity, distance, probability, and time. It is the source of many impossible places and artifacts.

Major Factions

The ocean is a deeply political ecosystem: - **The Free Captains Alliance (Blackwake Harbor)**: A pirate frontier valuing exploration and independence. - **The Grand Merchant Consortium (Port Meridian)**: A neutral trade power that doesn’t own the city, just everything inside it. - **The Crimson Dominion (The Crimson Citadel)**: A wealthy arcane empire built on slavery, magical superiority, and the exploitation of conquered peoples. They view Wayfinders and new routes as economic threats. - **The Drowned Silk Houses (Nymorath Deep Harbor)**: An ancient Drow Underdark Ocean civilization. They raid the surface for resources, ancient claims, and political warfare. They remember the First Captains. - **The Spirit Keepers (The Last Harbor)**: A hidden sanctuary of guardians preserving old traditions, Navigator Spirits, and First Captain lore. - **Independent Salvagers (Salvager’s Haven)**: A frontier port of wreck hunters, explorers, and forgotten discoveries.

Chapter 2: Starting Origins

Every Wayfinder campaign begins with a shipwreck. The party does not start with a ship; they start with survival.

The Tide’s Choice

There are two opening methods to determine where and how the players begin their adventure.

Method A: The Captain’s Choice

“I chose where I wanted to go. The sea decided how I arrived.”

The player chooses their **Home Port** and starting faction environment. The sea (via random dice rolls or GM selection) determines: - Shipwreck Cause - Rescue Vessel - Rescue Circumstances - Initial Reputation

Method B: The Sea’s Choice

“I surrendered my destination, but I wrote my legend.”

The player rolls randomly for their **Home Port**, letting fate decide their starting faction, local allies, and initial enemies. In return, the player chooses: - Shipwreck Cause - Rescue Vessel - Arrival Circumstance

Shipwreck Causes

The reason the ship went down shapes the player's initial mystery and backstory. Causes include: - Leviathan attack - Magical storm / Psionic distortion - Drow naval assault / Crimson Dominion experiment - Pirate battle / Mutiny / Betrayal - Ancient defense system activated - Underdark Ocean current breach / Planar ocean anomaly - Ship vanished and reappeared damaged

Rescue Vessels & Circumstances

The rescuers do not necessarily know they are rescuing someone important. The ship that pulls you from the water determines your first relationship and faction tie.

Rescuer Options

- **Blackwake Connection:** A pirate exploration vessel hunting for treasure.
- **Port Meridian Connection:** A merchant expedition charting routes.
- **Crimson Dominion Connection:** A slaver/arcane vessel that recognizes something unusual about your survival.
- **Drow Connection:** Drow scouts drifting near an Underdark Ocean route.
- **Spirit Keeper Connection:** A vessel guided by spirits, deliberately looking for you.
- **Salvager Connection:** Wreck hunters where you are just another survivor.

Arrival Circumstances

How you are treated on the rescue ship heavily influences your arrival at the Home Port: - **Honored Guest:** Treated well. - **Prisoner:** Rescued, but questioned and held under suspicion. - **Debt Owed:** Saved, but expecting repayment. - **Mystery Passenger:** The crew does not understand why you survived. - **Prophecy/Recognition:** Someone on the ship knows exactly what you are.

Chapter 3: Races & Transformations

The base race of this setting is the **Tideborn Pixie**, but players do not stay “just” pixies. As they explore the oceans, they undergo the **Fey Transformation System**, accumulating templates that reflect the magic, ruins, and pacts they encounter.

Base Race: Tideborn Pixie

“A Pixie born from ocean currents, ancient routes, and the forgotten magic between shores.”

Type: Fey (Small) **Speed:** 20 ft. Land / 60 ft. Fly (Good) / 30 ft. Swim (Good) **Ability Adjustments:** Str -4, Dex +8, Int +6, Wis +4, Cha +8

Racial Traits: - **Tideborn Amphibious Nature:** Ignores underwater movement penalties and natural ocean terrain penalties. Can breathe underwater 1 hr/HD/day (permanent at 5 HD). - **Fey Sight:** Low-light vision. **Spirit Sight:** Detect Fey/Spirits/Magical Residue at will (30 ft. range). - **Fey Magic:** Original 3.0 Pixie Spell-Like Abilities. - **Polymorph:** The original 3.0 Pixie Polymorph ability (self only). Cannot gain spell-like, supernatural, or extraordinary abilities from the new form. - **Psionic Spark:** Base Power Points = 1/2 Character Level + Cha Mod (min 1). Start with one power: *Detect Psionics*, *Far Hand*, or *Minor Metamorphosis*.

The Fey Transformation System

Players may acquire transformations during their journeys. These are not simply chosen from a menu; they are earned or inflicted by the world.

Transformation Capacity: A character has a maximum of **4 Transformation Points**. **Ability Score Stacking Rule:** No ability score can gain more than a +6 total bonus strictly from templates. (Base Tideborn Pixie bonuses are unaffected).

Category A: Minor Marks

Limit: Max 2 | **Cost:** 1 Transformation Point Minor changes caused by magical exposure, blessings, mutations, or small awakenings. - **Fey-Touched (+2 Cha):** Pure fey awakening. +2 Diplomacy/Bluff/Perform. *Minor Glamour* (Silent Image 1/day). - **Stormborn Fey (+2 Dex):** Ocean storms. Electricity Resist 5. Wind Rider (flight maneuverability up one step). Storm Sense (+2 Spot, Survival, Sailor). - **Coral-Blooded Fey (+2 Con):** Reef adaptation. Natural Armor +1. Improved underwater survival. - **Moonlit Fey (+2 Wis):** Lunar tide magic. Darkvision 30 ft. Lunar Grace (+2 Dodge AC at night). Dream Whisper 1/day. - **Shadowwake Fey (+2 Dex):** Dark ocean. 10% concealment in dim light. Darkvision 30 ft. Shadow Step (10 ft. teleport between shadows 1/day). - **Psionic Spark Fey (+2 Int):** Mind awakening. +3 PP. Minor Psionic Talent (one power). +1 vs mind-affecting. - **Spirit Marked Fey (+2 Wis):** Spirit connection. Gain a minor spirit companion. Spirit Awareness (30 ft.). +1 resistance to saves. - **Draconic Spark Fey (+2 Con):** Dormant dragon ancestry. Resist 5 to one element. Blindsense 30 ft. Minor breath weapon (1/day, 1d4, 15ft cone). - **Arcane Marked Fey (+2 Int):** Minor magical mutation. +1 against spells. Minor arcane trick (cantrip at will). +1 caster level for one school.

Category B: Awakening Templates

Limit: Max 1 | **Cost:** 2 Transformation Points A fundamental evolution of the character. - **Awakened Fey (+2 Int, +2 Wis, +2 Cha):** Psionic evolution. Gains Psionic subtype. PP = HD + Int + Cha. One Psionic Discipline & 1st level power. +4 vs enchantments/mind-affecting. Lifespan x5, no aging penalties. - **Arcane Ascendant Fey (+2 Int, +2 Cha):** Deep magic conduit. Gains Arcane Reservoir (1 bonus spell slot lower than max). Spellweaver Soul (+2 caster checks for one school). Resistance 10 to one element. Arcane Memory (recall witnessed spell 1/day). - **Spirit-Bound Fey (+2 Wis, +2 Cha):** Spirit Shaman evolution. Navigator Spirit manifests physically. +2 on spirit-related checks. Ancestral Memory (+10 Knowledge 1/day). Spirit Walk

(ethereal 1 round/level, 1/day). - **First Captain Legacy Fey (+2 Int, +2 Wis, +2 Cha):** Lost Wayfinder inheritance. +4 Sailor, Survival, Geography. Captain’s Echo (visions from past Wayfinders). Improved Ship Bond progression. Lost Route Memory (recognize ancient routes 1/week).

Category C: Heritage Templates

Limit: Max 1 | **Cost:** 3 Transformation Points Changes what the character is fundamentally. - **Draconic Fey (+2 Str, +2 Con, +2 Int, +2 Cha):** Dragon lineage. Element Resistance 10. Blindsense 30 ft. Breath weapon (1d6/HD, max 10d6, 1/day). - **Celestial Tide Fey (+2 Con, +2 Wis, +2 Cha):** Divine blessing. Good alignment. Acid/Cold/Elec Resist 10. Divine Grace (Cha to saves). Radiant Presence (+1 morale to allies’ saves). - **Infernal Fey (+2 Con, +2 Int, +4 Cha):** Infernal pact. Lawful alignment. Fire Resist 15. Contract Mind (+4 vs charm/domination). Infernal Boon (Hellfire or Binding Word). - **Xoriat-Touched Fey (+4 Int, +2 Wis, -2 Cha):** Reality mutation. Aberration subtype. Immune to confusion/insanity. Reality Fracture (reroll 1 failed d20 per day). Impossible Anatomy (20% miss chance). - **Chimera Fey (+2 Str, +4 Con, +2 Int):** Engineered evolution. Gain two physical mutations (Predator, Aquatic, Winged, Armored, etc.). Mutable Anatomy (swap one mutation 1/day). +4 vs polymorph/transmutation.

Category D: Mythic Transformations (Campaign Locked)

Not purchased. Not selected. Earned through world-altering campaign events. - **Deep-Touched Fey (+4 Con, +2 Int, +2 Wis, +2 Cha):** Altered by the Underdark Ocean. Aberration/Aquatic traits. Darkvision 120 ft., Water breathing, Pressure immunity, Cold Resist 10. Abyssal Telepathy 60 ft. Deep Resonance (Bonus PP = Level + Cha). Unlocks an entire mythic evolution tree at levels 5, 10, 15, and 20. - **Abyssal Fey (+2 Con, +2 Int, +4 Cha):** Corrupted ocean magic. Evil alignment. Dark Tide abilities. Abyssal Mark (gain power but attract outsider attention). Speak with dead sailors.

Chapter 4: The Wayfinder Class

“A Wayfinder is not a swashbuckler with magic, a warlock with a boat, or a psion with a sword. The Wayfinder is the rediscovery of an ancient First Captain tradition where Arcane magic shapes reality, Psionics shapes perception, and Spirit magic shapes connection. At low levels, these are three separate disciplines. At high levels, the Wayfinder becomes someone who does not simply navigate the world—they alter the routes the world allows.”

Class Chassis

Hit Die: d8 **Alignment:** Any **Class Skills:** 8 + Int modifier per level. (Balance, Bluff, Concentration, Craft (Ships), Decipher Script, Diplomacy, Gather Information, Handle Animal, Intimidate, Knowledge (Arcana/Geography/History/Local/Nature/Psionics/Religion), Profession (Sailor), Search, Sense Motive, Spellcraft, Spot, Survival, Swim, UMD, UPD). **Base Attack Bonus:** Medium (+15 at Level 20). **Saving Throws:** Good Reflex and Will, Poor Fortitude. **Weapon & Armor Proficiency:** Simple weapons, martial light weapons, rapier, cutlass, hand crossbow, shortbow, longbow, firearms. Light armor (Medium at level 5), shields (except tower).

The Threefold Magic Systems

The Wayfinder progresses in three magical paths simultaneously. 1. **The Pact (Arcane)**: Warlock chassis. Uses Charisma. Eldritch Armament (can manifest Eldritch Blast through a weapon, harpoon, pistol, or standard blast) and Invocations. 2. **The Mind (Psionic)**: Psion chassis (half-progression, max 6th-level powers). Uses Charisma. Gains Power Points and discovers powers. 3. **The Tide (Spirit)**: Custom Spirit Shaman+ chassis. Full 1-9 spell progression but spells must be discovered/learned via the Captain's Log instead of prepared from a deity.

Lore-Caster (The Fusion Engine)

Instead of preparing spells, the Wayfinder uncovers **Wayfinding Lore**—an accumulated understanding of the world. - **Level 7 (Arcane-Psionic Fusion)**: Combine a spell and a power into one action (e.g., Fireball + Telekinesis = Moving Flame Sphere). - **Level 10 (Threefold Awakening - Triune Casting)**: 1/day, combine a Spell, a Power, and a Spirit Ability to open new paths to unseen locations. - **Level 17 (Reality Navigation)**: You do not teleport; you discover a path through solid fog, magical barriers, or impassable storms. - **Level 20 (Creator of Paths)**: Create permanent routes, impossible trade lanes, and open new ocean passages.

The Navigator Spirit

At level 1, the Wayfinder awakens a personal spirit companion—the “mirror” of the captain. 1. **Origin Seed**: Choose the spirit's foundational nature (e.g., Ancient Navigator, Stormborn, Abyssal, Leviathan, Ancestor Captain, Ghost Fleet). 2. **Seed Benefit**: A deliberate expression of the spirit (e.g., Storm Sense, Lost Routes, Deep Survival). 3. **Random Traits**: Roll 2d100 for an Innate Trait and an Emergent Trait (e.g., Ancient Memory, Hates Calm Waters, Echo of Darkness). 4. **Evolution**: The spirit evolves at levels 5, 10, 15, and 20 based on the captain's actions (e.g., Guardian Aspect, Sage Aspect, Dominator Aspect, Pathfinder Aspect). At level 20, it becomes the embodiment of your legend.

The Living Ship Bond

The ship is your second character. It advances through **Vessel Tiers** via Wayfinder Level, Chronicle Achievements, and Physical Transformation. - **Tier 0 (Mortal Ship)**: Normal vessel with maintenance costs. - **Tier 1 (Claimed Vessel - Lvl 3)**: Ship recognizes you. You sense its condition. - **Tier 2 (Awakened Vessel - Lvl 6)**: Gains intelligence/personality. Becomes an Arcane, Psionic, or Tide vessel. - **Tier 3 (Legendary Vessel - Lvl 10)**: Threefold Keel. Can install Arcane, Psionic, and Tide upgrades (e.g., Eldritch Cannons, Psychic Helm, Storm Calling). - **Tier 4 (Mythic Vessel - Lvl 15)**: Requires rare materials (dragon bone, deep crystal). Gains traits like Ghost Ship or World Sailor. - **Tier 5 (Path-Maker Vessel - Lvl 20)**: Creates permanent passages through reality. The ship changes the map of the world.

Chapter 5a: Captain's Techniques (Rules & Framework)

“Every captain leaves behind stories. The First Captains left behind techniques.”

A Captain’s Technique is not a spell, a maneuver, or a psionic power. It is a legendary trick, habit, doctrine, or philosophy that has become supernatural through repetition and authority. The Wayfinder learns 6 Captain’s Techniques over their career (at levels 3, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18), though class features/milestones may grant more.

Mechanics

- **Save DC Formula:** $10 + 1/2 \text{ Wayfinder Level} + \text{Charisma Modifier}$.
- **Usage Limits:** Unless stated otherwise, they are generally at-will or have specific per-encounter/per-day limits outlined in their text.
- **Action Types:** Standard D&D 3.5e actions (Standard, Move, Swift, Immediate, Passive/Special).
 - *Global Rule:* A Wayfinder may only use **one Immediate Action Captain’s Technique per round** to prevent reaction bloat.

Categories

Each category has a unique gameplay identity. If a technique solves a problem, the category defines *how* it solves it. 1. **Seamanship:** Environmental mastery. Navigation, ship handling, weather, avoiding hazards. “How do I move through the world?” 2. **Duelist:** Personal combat mastery. Precision, ripostes, officer challenges, exploiting openings. “How do I win this fight?” 3. **Corsair:** Aggressive raider. Boarding, fear, plunder, breaking defenses (siege). “How do I break the enemy?” (*Note: Corsair siege techniques create vulnerabilities, not automatic destruction*). 4. **Fleet:** Tactical commander. Coordination, formations, positioning. “How do we fight as one?” (*Note: A creature can benefit from only one Fleet command effect at a time*). 5. **Hunter:** Tracking and pursuit. Reconnaissance, interception, elimination. “How do I find what is hidden?” 6. **Mystic:** Keeper of sea secrets. Sea magic, omens, supernatural navigation. “What does the world reveal?” (*Note: Mystic info provides clues/probabilities, not perfect answers*). 7. **First Captain:** Sovereign commander. Leadership, territory, diplomacy, political authority. “How do I build influence?” (*Note: Creates leverage and reputation, not automatic obedience*).

The Tiers

1. **Least (Levels 1-5):** *The Deckhand Becomes an Officer.* Focuses on personal skill, small tactical advantages, basic navigation. Scale: Self/1 Ally.
 2. **Lesser (Levels 6-11):** *The Officer Becomes a Captain.* Focuses on crew coordination, resource efficiency, and boarding dominance. Scale: Small squad/Ship.
 3. **Greater (Levels 12-17):** *The Captain Becomes an Admiral.* Encounter-defining commands, fleet tactics, environmental manipulation. Scale: Entire battlefield.
 4. **Legendary (Levels 18-20):** *The Admiral Becomes the First Captain.* Maritime sovereignty, campaign-scale influence, world map changes. Scale: Regions/Factions/Campaigns. (*Note: Permanent world-changing effects require time, resources, and narrative consequences*).
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Chapter 5b: Least Captain's Techniques (Levels 1-5)

These techniques establish the Wayfinder's earliest identity. They emphasize positioning, environment, precision, and skill over raw statistical bonuses.

Seamanship Techniques

1. Sea Legs (Passive, Self): Ignore movement penalties from pitching decks, slick surfaces, rigging. Stand from prone as a swift action on a vessel. **2. Chart the Unknown (Standard, Area within 1 mile):** Study terrain/currents for 1 min. Create a mental chart. Learn safe routes, unexplored regions, or if a route is artificial. (Reveals geography only). **3. Favor the Current (Swift, Self, 1 round):** Ignore difficult terrain caused by water, mud, sand, snow, or loose stone for 1 round. **4. Mooring Line (Move, 30 ft.):** Secure a rope/chain expertly. Allies crossing ignore the first Balance/Climb check. **5. Read the Wind (Standard, Self):** Learn local weather trends, wind direction, and if dangerous natural weather is likely in the next few hours. **6. Shorefinder (Passive, Self):** Always know the direction of the nearest coastline, river outlet, harbor, or navigable shoreline while outdoors.

Duelist Techniques

7. Opening Measure (Swift, 1 melee opponent, 1 round): If your next melee attack hits them this turn, you may take a 5-ft step that doesn't count against normal movement. **8. Crossed Steel (Immediate, Self):** When an adjacent opponent misses you, draw a weapon, switch grips, or reposition weapon without provoking attacks of opportunity. **9. Press the Guard (Standard, 1 opponent):** Hit with an attack to deny the target a 5-ft step before the start of your next turn. **10. Low Feint (Swift, 1 opponent within 30 ft):** The first ally to attack the target before your next turn gains a circumstance advantage (distraction/false opening). **11. Recover Balance (Immediate, Self):** Reduce involuntary movement by 5 ft, or remain standing if forced movement was 5 ft or less. **12. Captain's Challenge (Swift, 1 opponent within 30 ft, 1 round):** If they move away, they provoke from you. If they attack an ally instead of you, you gain +2 on your next attack against them.

Corsair Techniques

13. First Over the Rail (Move, Self): Move normal speed without provoking AoO from the first enemy you pass when boarding/climbing. **14. Break the Line (Standard, Adjacent enemy):** Make melee attack. If successful, target must give ground 5 ft or lose AoO until start of your next turn (Will negates). **15. Claim the Prize (Swift, 1 enemy damaged this turn):** First ally to attack target can move 5 ft before or after without provoking AoO. **16. Boarding Hook (Move, 30 ft.):** Pull yourself to a fixed point or pull an unattended object (up to heavy load limit) toward you. **17. Find the Weak Board (Standard, Object/Structure within 30 ft):** Identify weak point. First attack within 10 mins ignores 2 hardness, reduces repair DC, or creates an opening.

(Uses/day = Cha mod). **18. False Surrender (Standard, 1 creature within 30 ft):** Bluff vs Sense Motive. Target gets -2 on next attack vs you and cannot make AoO against you until your next turn.

Fleet Techniques

19. Captain's Signal (Swift, 1 ally within 30 ft): Ally can immediately take a 5-ft step. **20. Tight Formation (Standard, Allies within 10 ft):** Allies can delay actions until immediately after another affected ally acts. Lasts 1 round. **21. Crew Rotation (Immediate, 2 willing allies within 30 ft):** Swap two allies' positions if attacked or forced to move. Doesn't provoke AoO, max 5 ft. **22. Cover the Retreat (Immediate, 1 ally within 30 ft):** When ally moves away from enemy, grant 5-ft bonus movement that doesn't provoke AoO. **23. Shared Burden (Standard, 1 ally within 30 ft):** Reduce forced movement on an ally by 5 ft for 1 round. **24. Quartermaster's Eye (Standard, Vessel/Camp in sight):** Inspect for 1 min. Accurately estimate food, water, ammo, common goods, shortages within 10% accuracy.

Hunter Techniques

25. Saltmark Trail (Standard, Touched creature/object, 24 hr): Place invisible tracking mark. Sense direction within 1 mile (Will negates). **26. Read the Wake (Standard, 30 ft area):** Determine recent movement, numbers, size, direction, and rough timeframe of passage. **27. Hidden Anchorage (Passive, Self):** Recognize natural concealment for ships/camps, ambush locations, and concealed approaches. **28. Ambush Route (Standard, 60 ft area):** Determine optimal approach/escape/engagement point. Allies gain +2 on first Stealth/Survival/Initiative check related to it (lasts 1 hr). **29. Mark the Quarry (Swift, 1 creature within 60 ft):** Know direction of their movement the first time they hide/withdraw before end of your next turn. **30. Expedition Sense (Passive/Special, Self):** +2 on Survival to identify natural hazards/poison. Observe 1 min to auto-detect obvious mundane hazards.

Mystic Techniques

31. Omen of the Tide (Standard, Self): Ask a simple question about a voyage/decision. Receive a symbolic omen indicating favorable/unfavorable conditions. **32. Whispering Compass (Standard, Self, 1 hr):** Always know direction of a known destination/landmark you've visited. **33. Storm Listener (Passive, Self):** Sense approaching natural storms, abnormal atmospheric patterns, or supernatural weather (but not its source). **34. Sea Ward (Standard, Touch, 24 hr):** Temporary ward on vessel/camp/object. Tampering provides a brief supernatural warning visible only to you. **35. Echo of the Deep (Standard, Touched object/location):** Receive a brief symbolic sensory impression of its strongest recent event. **36. Salt Circle (Standard, 5 ft radius, 10 min):** Protective space. +2 circumstance bonus on saves vs fear and environmental hazards for creatures inside.

First Captain Techniques

37. Captain's Reputation (Passive, Self): Gain a competence bonus equal to half Wayfinder level on Diplomacy and Knowledge (local) in maritime communities. **38. Commander's Assessment (Standard, Group/Org within 30 ft):** Observe 1 min. Determine one obvious organizational weakness (morale, supplies,

discipline, etc.). **39. Quartermaster's Ledger (Passive, Self):** Maintain accurate records. Cannot accidentally lose track of mundane resources personally managed. **40. Mark of Safe Passage (Standard, Settlement/Org, 30 days):** Establish minor connection for basic hospitality and non-hostile treatment (unless offended). **41. Whisper Network (Passive, Self):** In a settlement >100 people after 1 week, obtain rumors (dangers, notable figures, opportunities). **42. Reserve the Hold (Special, Container/Supply):** 1/day designate an emergency reserve. Know its location/contents and if disturbed. +2 on checks to manage it. **43. Captain's Word (Standard, Willing creature within 30 ft):** Grant +10 ft movement or free action to draw/stow item. **44. Banner of the Rising Tide (Standard, Allies within 30 ft, 1 hr):** Display symbol. Allies recognize genuine orders. 1/day grant +1 morale to fear saves for 1 hour.

Chapter 5c: Lesser Captain's Techniques (Levels 6-11)

These techniques emphasize escort control, boarding pressure, command tempo, shipboard dominance, and field adaptability.

Seamanship Techniques

1. Running Tide Advance (Swift, Self & Allies within 20 ft): Ignore first 10 ft of movement penalties from shallow water, loose deck debris, or slick surfaces until next turn. **2. Storm-True Bearing (Standard, Self & up to 4 allies, 10 min):** +4 competence bonus to navigate through storms, fog, current, poor visibility. (Must be on vessel/near water). **3. Brace the Spars (Immediate, Structure/Creature in sight):** Reduce forced movement/stability penalty by 5 when a ship/mast/structure suffers force or collision. **4. Keelwalker's Poise (Swift, Self):** +4 Balance/Climb, no Balance checks for moving normal speed on decks/narrow footing until next turn. **5. Harbormouth Timing (Standard, 1 Ally within 30 ft):** Ally may immediately take a 5-ft step even if movement is expended, provided they are on a vessel/maritime structure. **6. Weather the Plunge (Immediate, Self/Adjacent ally):** Reduce falling distance by 20 ft when falling from a ship, cliff, dock, or rigging. **7. Tacking Shift (Move, Self):** Change movement direction without provoking AoO from one creature that threatened you, if moving across maritime terrain/docks.

Duelist Techniques

8. Harpoon Opening (Standard, 1 creature): Hit with a melee weapon; target takes -2 penalty to attack anyone except you until your next turn. **9. Saltwater Parry (Immediate, Self):** When hit by melee attack, gain +4 AC against that attack. **10. Cutter's Line (Swift, 1 creature):** Hit an enemy; they cannot take 5-ft steps until your next turn. **11. Captain's Pressure (Move, Threatened foe):** Foe takes -2 penalty on AoO against you and adjacent allies until next turn. **12. Rip Tide Counter (Immediate, Self):** When adjacent ally is hit by melee, move 5 ft and make a melee attack against the attacker at -2. **13. Breach and Bind (Standard, 1 creature):** Melee attack. On hit, target takes -4 to Escape Artist/grapple until next turn. **14. Duelist's Claim (Swift, 1 foe within 30 ft):** +2 melee attack against them until next turn. Allies gain +1 on AoO against it.

Corsair Techniques

15. Boarding Rush (Standard, Self): Move up to speed in a straight line. If ending adjacent to enemy, +2 on next melee attack this turn. **16. Cut the Rigging (Standard, 30 ft):** Disable one section of rope/sails/ladder/nets. Imposes -4 penalty on checks using that item until repaired. **17. Smoke Through the Gaps (Move, Self):** +4 Hide/Tumble in crowded, cluttered, or partially blocked spaces until next turn. **18. Plunder Step (Swift, Self):** If moving at least 10 ft, retrieve or stow one small object during movement without provoking AoO. **19. Rake the Deck (Standard, 1 creature):** Melee attack. On hit, target takes -2 Balance and cannot benefit from shipboard cover until next turn. **20. Grapple the Horizon (Move, Tiny/smaller object):** Grapple unattended object, tackle, or obstacle as if one size category larger to move it. **21. Boarding Party's Wake (Immediate, Self/Ally):** When you/ally charges, the first ally to follow the same target next round gains +2 on that movement/attack.

Fleet Techniques

22. Command Vector (Swift, 1 ally within 60 ft): +2 competence bonus on movement-based checks or attacks during movement this round. **23. Formation Shift (Move, up to 3 allies within 30 ft):** They may adjust 5 ft without provoking AoO if keeping in combat formation. **24. Hold the Wake (Immediate, 1 ally within 30 ft):** Prevent ally from provoking AoO from one chosen creature when moving. **25. Cannon-Ready Mind (Standard, up to 4 allies within 30 ft):** +2 initiative if not rolled; else one ally rerolls failed initiative 1/encounter. **26. Deckline Coordination (Standard, Allies within 20 ft, 1 min):** +2 Aid Another, and checks to climb, haul, row, load. **27. Signal Denial (Immediate, Enemy within 60 ft):** Impose -4 to enemy commander's check or negate one simple tactical instruction. **28. Tighten the Net (Standard, adjacent 10-ft square):** First enemy moving through treats it as difficult terrain until next turn. **29. Crew's Second Breath (Swift, 1 ally within 30 ft):** Recover from shaken, or +2 morale save against fatigue/exhaustion.

Hunter Techniques

30. Pursuit Reading (Standard, Self, 10 min): +4 Survival to follow tracks, spoor, or wake disturbances. **31. Predatory Silence (Swift, Self):** +4 Hide, no penalty for moving half speed while hiding until next turn. **32. Trail Snare (Standard, 10-ft square):** First creature to enter must Reflex save or speed reduced by 10 ft until end of its next turn. **33. Bite of the Chosen Range (Swift, 1 visible enemy):** Next ranged attack against them gains +2 and ignores soft cover this turn. **34. Corner the Quarry (Standard, 1 enemy within 60 ft):** They take -2 on checks to tumble, climb, swim, or escape through terrain you can observe. **35. Patient Ambush (Full-round, Self):** If you remain still until next turn, +4 attack against a creature that hasn't acted in combat yet. **36. Blood in the Water (Immediate, 1 creature within 30 ft):** When creature drops below half HP, +2 attack against them until next turn.

Mystic Techniques

37. Deepward Aura (Swift, Self & Allies 10 ft): +2 save vs fear, charm, compulsion until next turn. **38. Tideward Insight (Standard, Self, 1 min):** +4 Sense Motive/Gather Info to detect lies, hidden intentions, manipulation. **39. Lantern of the Black Wake (Standard, 1 ally within 30 ft, 10 min):** Grant low-light vision,

or +2 Spot if they have it. **40. Veil Against Salted Eyes (Immediate, Self/Ally within 30 ft):** Targeted by gaze attack: impose -2 penalty to attacker's accuracy or force 50% chance gaze fails. **41. Murmur of the Hull (Standard, Touching structure):** Ask one yes-or-no question about a ship/door/wall integrity, damage, or compromise. **42. Salt-Bound Reprieve (Immediate, 1 ally within 30 ft):** Ally fails Fort save vs disease/poison/environment; grant +2 to the result retroactively. **43. Rime of Calm Waters (Standard, 10 ft radius, 1 min):** Suppress one minor environmental penalty (light spray, wind, deck shake) for you/allies.

First Captain Techniques

44. Issue the Pursuit (Swift, 1 ally within 30 ft): +2 attack against target you have already damaged or named this encounter. **45. Anchor the Line (Standard, up to 4 allies within 20 ft):** +2 check/save vs forced movement, trip, bull rush until next turn. **46. Captain's Repositioning (Immediate, 1 ally within 30 ft):** If adjacent to enemy, ally may shift 5 ft to a legal square without provoking from that enemy. **47. Order of the Clean Escape (Standard, up to 3 allies within 30 ft):** May move half speed without provoking AoO from one designated creature. **48. Speak as One Voice (Swift, Allies within 30 ft):** +2 on one coordinated action, Aid Another, or group skill check until next turn. **49. Unbroken Bearing (Immediate, Self/Ally within 30 ft):** Fails a saving throw; grant +2 after the roll. **50. First Through the Wake (Standard, 1 ally within 30 ft):** Gains +2 attack and saves if they move to engage the same target you attacked this round.

Chapter 5d: Greater Captain's Techniques (Levels 12-17)

These techniques shape encounters through movement control, battlefield pressure, crew coordination, tactical denial, and decisive command. They reshape terrain, tempo, and morale.

Seamanship Techniques

1. Breakwater Surge (Standard, Self & Allies 30 ft, 1 round): Ignore nonmagical difficult terrain from water/wreckage/clutter. +4 to resist being knocked prone by motion/impact. **2. Whitecap Passage (Move, Self & 2 adjacent allies):** Move half speed across water/foam/unstable surface without falling or provoking AoO. **3. Keel-Sure Command (Immediate, Structure within 60 ft):** Reduce severity of force/impact/collapse by one step for all creatures on the structure until next turn. **4. Tidehook Maneuver (Standard, 1 creature/object 60 ft):** Ranged touch attack; pull target up to 15 ft towards you. Reflex save or denied 5-ft steps until next turn. **5. Undertow Footing (Swift, Self & Allies 20 ft):** +4 on opposed checks/saves vs bull rush, trip, overrun, forced movement until next turn. **6. Harborless Escape (Standard, up to 3 allies within 30 ft):** Move up to speed through shallow water/debris without provoking AoO from one designated enemy each.

Duelist Techniques

7. Captain's Duel (Swift, 1 foe within 30 ft): +4 melee attack against them until next turn. Foe takes -2 to attack anyone else. **8. Crosscut Momentum (Standard, 1 creature):** Melee attack. On hit, force 10-ft reposition toward a square adjacent to you. **9. Break Their Guard (Standard, 1 creature):** Melee attack. On hit, target loses dodge AC against your allies until next turn. **10. High-Line Riposte (Immediate, Self):** Missed by melee attack: move 10 ft and make a melee attack against attacker. If hit, they cannot take AoO until end of their next turn. **11. Cut the Escape (Swift, Threatened foe):** Target cannot 5-ft step away without a Reflex save. **12. Duelist's Denial (Immediate, Threatened foe):** Foe casting spell/power/ranged attack: force Concentration check or -4 penalty on the attack. **13. Bloodline Reading (Move, 1 foe):** Gain +4 insight to attack and AC against one foe whose style you observed this combat until next turn.

Corsair Techniques

14. Boarding Storm (Full-round, Self): Move up to speed, make 1 melee attack during movement. If ending adjacent to a different enemy, 1 ally within 30 ft can reaction move 10 ft without provoking. **15. Black Flag Feint (Swift, 1 enemy within 60 ft):** Enemy takes -2 Will vs fear/intimidate until next turn. **16. Rope-Swing Cut (Move, Self):** Move 20 ft using rigging/ropes. Melee attack at the end without provoking AoO from first creature passed. **17. Prize the Deck (Standard, 10-ft square):** Area becomes difficult terrain. Enemies take -2 to remain upright there until next turn. **18. Loot-Driven Advance (Swift, Self & 1 adjacent ally):** After dropping/disarming/fleeing a foe, gain +2 to movement and attack rolls until next turn. **19. Hullbreaker Strike (Standard, 1 creature):** Melee attack. On hit, target takes AC penalty equal to your Cha mod against your attacks until next turn. **20. Pirate's Surround (Immediate, Self):** Adjacent ally hits foe: shift 5 ft and gain +2 on your next melee attack against them.

Fleet Techniques

21. Command the Wake (Swift, up to 4 allies 60 ft): May each move 5 ft without provoking AoO. **22. Volley Timing (Standard, up to 3 allies):** Next attack by each before your next turn gains +2 attack/damage if attacking the same target. **23. Interlocking Line (Immediate, 1 ally within 30 ft):** Ally would be flanked: designate adjacent ally as second defender, negating flank bonus for 1 round. **24. Boarding Signal (Standard, Allies 30 ft):** May immediately draw weapon, don shield, or ready charged item without provoking AoO. **25. Press the Advantage (Swift, 1 impaired enemy):** Allies within 30 ft gain +2 attack against that shaken/prone/flat-footed enemy until next turn. **26. Crew on the Railing (Immediate, 1 ally within 30 ft):** Ally forced to move/fall prone: remain standing and reduce displacement by 5 ft. **27. Formation of Iron (Full-round, Allies within 20 ft):** Gain either +2 morale AC OR +2 morale saves (not both) while remaining in formation for 1 round/level. **28. Tactical Relay (Swift, 1 ally within 60 ft):** Ally may repeat a movement/Aid/positioning action taken this round, but at a -2 penalty.

Hunter Techniques

29. Killbox Reading (Standard, 15-ft square): First enemy entering takes -2 Reflex and cannot benefit from cover inside the area until your next turn. **30. Scent the Weak Point (Move, 1 enemy):** Gain +4 to identify weak defense/escape. First ally to attack them gains +2 attack. **31. Marlin Strike (Standard, 1 creature):** Ranged attack. On hit, target's speed reduced by 10 ft and cannot use special movement actions until next

turn. **32. Corner the Escape (Immediate, 1 creature 60 ft):** Attempts to withdraw/teleport/escape: Will save or lose first 10 ft of movement. **33. Hunt the Panic (Swift, 1 frightened/panicked enemy 60 ft):** Takes -2 on attack, skill, saves for 1 round. **34. Deadwater Ambush (Full-round, Self):** If stationary, next attack vs enemy that hasn't acted yet is +4 and ignores mist/dim light concealment. **35. Marked Expenditure (Standard, 1 damaged creature):** Target takes -2 on checks/spells to regenerate, recover, or benefit from invisibility/concealment until next turn.

Mystic Techniques

36. Abyssal Quiet (Swift, Self & Allies 10 ft): +4 save vs fear, compulsion, sonic effects until next turn. **37. Salt-Rune Interdict (Immediate, 1 creature 60 ft):** Casting spell/using supernatural ability: impose Concentration check or reduce effect's caster level by 2. **38. Lantern of the Undertow (Standard, Allies 20 ft, 1 min):** Gain See Invisibility against creatures in water/mist/fog/spray. **39. Dreadcurrent Ward (Immediate, 1 ally 30 ft):** Fails save vs enchantment/fear/illusion: reroll with +2 bonus. **40. Wake-Sense Abjuration (Standard, Self & Allies 20 ft, 10 min):** +4 to notice scrying, hidden watchers, ambushes, unnatural disturbances. **41. Tidal Resistance (Swift, Self & Allies 10 ft):** Resistance 10 against Acid, Cold, and Electricity until next turn. **42. Echo of the Deep Name (Standard, 1 creature 60 ft):** Learn one fact: exact health, creature type, or if under magical influence. (No exact numbers, symbolic).

First Captain Techniques

43. Hold the Future Line (Swift, Allies 30 ft): +2 morale attack and saves until next turn, provided they remain within 30 ft. **44. Directive Overwatch (Immediate, 1 ally 30 ft):** Targeted by attack: grant +4 AC against that one attack. **45. Named Objective (Standard, 1 enemy/goal 60 ft):** Allies gain +2 on attack rolls and opposed checks related to that target until next turn. **46. March Under Command (Move, up to 4 allies 30 ft):** Take a 10-ft move without provoking AoO, keeping formation. **47. No One Breaks Alone (Immediate, 1 ally 30 ft):** Stunned/panicked/unconscious: reduce condition severity one step for 1 round or grant +4 on the save. **48. Compel Formation (Standard, up to 3 allies 30 ft):** Reposition 5 ft and gain +2 AC vs AoO until next turn. **49. Voice of Final Tempo (Swift, 1 ally 30 ft):** Take an extra move action immediately. Cannot use more than 1/encounter per ally. **50. The Captain Advances (Immediate, Self):** Reduced below half HP: allies 30 ft gain +2 morale to attacks and saves for 1 round.

Chapter 5e: Legendary Captain's Techniques (Levels 18-20)

Legendary techniques alter voyages, fleets, exploration, and faction play. They are capstone-tier commands meant to change the map itself. *Note: Permanent world-changing effects require time, resources, and narrative consequences. They provide influence, opportunities, and strategic advantage, not automatic control.*

Voyage, Route, and Navigation

1. Crown the Course (1-hour ritual): Name known destination on same plane. For 24 hrs, ship cannot become lost, ignores one nonmagical travel hazard, travels double pace if path exists. **2. Sovereign Wake (Swift, Allies 60 ft, 1 min/level):** Allies ignore penalties from wind, waves, shallow water, motion. Move across water/unstable surfaces as firm ground. **3. Breaker of Blockades (Standard, Obstruction 200 ft, 1 min/level):** Obstruction (boom, reef, siege barrier) is nonbinding to your vessel. Magical barriers must pass CL check or be suppressed 1 round. **4. Compass of Names (1-min ritual):** Name known creature/ship/harbor. Learn direction/approximate distance if on same plane, and if direct route is blocked. **5. Chart the Unseen Coast (Standard, 1 hr/level):** Reveal hidden coves/reefs/channels/secret routes within 1 mile/level. Allies gain navigation advantage, natural hazards cannot surprise. **6. Map of Ash and Wake (10-min ritual):** Create living tactical chart out to 1 mile/level showing routes, ruins, recent mass movements. +Bonus to nav/strategy/ambush-prevention for 24 hrs. **7. The Map Kneels (1-hour ritual):** Alter nonmagical terrain in 1-mile radius (shift sandbars, carve channels). Lasts 24 hrs. (Repeated 7 days makes permanent). **8. Unnamed Harbor (10-min ritual):** Designate concealed anchorage. For 24 hrs, vessel rests without mundane detection. Enemies must physically search.

Ship Combat and Quarterdeck Authority

9. Ship of the Line (Full-round, Vessel, 10 min/level): Vessel becomes mythic. Speed increases, hull harder to breach, weapons strike harder, crew gains strong morale. **10. Sovereign Quarterdeck (1-hour ritual, 24 hr):** Controlled vessel/fortress becomes sovereign nexus. Allies gain defense/coordination, you may issue command effects as if physically present. **11. Fleet in the Mind (Standard, 24 hr):** Telepathic command network among willing allies/crew within 1 mile/level bearing your mark. Coordinate as if adjacent. **12. Admiral's Oath (10-min ritual, 24 hr):** Bind up to 12 willing allies. Immunity to fear/charm, each rerolls one failed save vs sworn enemy/threat once per duration. **13. Wake of Dread Authority (Standard, 120 ft):** Enemies seeing your banner/vessel must Will save or become shaken for 1 min (frightened 1 round if already shaken). **14. Tide of Reprisal (Immediate):** When ship/crew is damaged by naval assault/monster, trigger counterstroke: vessel moves half speed, one allied ship/crew action occurs as reaction. **15. Chain the Storm (Full-round, 1-mile radius, 10 min/level):** Command weather. Calm sea, strengthen wind, steer storm, or lash enemy vessels with penalties. **16. Through the Needle's Eye (Immediate, 1 min):** When vessel would be trapped/grounded, reduce effective width/clearance requirement by half. Ignore first collision. **17. The World Makes Room (Standard, 100-ft path, 1 min/level):** Natural obstacles part/shift/yield enough for ship to pass. **18. Cut the Pursuit (1-hour ritual, 24 hr):** Ship/crew cannot be tracked by mundane means, magical tracking needs opposed check. Leave misleading wake/trail.

Exploration, Faction Play, and Sovereignty

19. First Captain's Judgment (Swift, 1 faction/leader, 24 hr): Declare enemy leader/faction. Allies gain advantage acting against their agents/assets. Disguised members easier to identify. **20. Claim the Island (8-hour ritual, 30 days):** Claim controlled fort/harbor. Authority treated as legitimate by neutral powers. Safe harbor, supply, patrol benefits. **21. Last Harbor Promise (1-hour ritual, 24 hr):** Establish hidden sanctuary. Allies can rest safely, cannot be surprised unless physically infiltrated, resist scrying. **22. Banners of Every Port (Standard, 24 hr):** Display insignia. Treated as recognized hospitality by neutral maritime communities/dockmasters. Major bonus to negotiation/access. **23. Sea-Law's Verdict (Standard, 1**

round/level): In a dispute/duel/boarding, impose temporary law: no outside aid, no hidden repositioning, no retreat by opposing leader (Will negates). **24. First Captain Ascendant (Swift, 1 round/level):** Living embodiment of command. Allies gain major morale to attacks/saves/coordination. Commands reach through battlefield noise. **25. The World Follows the Flag (1-hour ritual, 30 days):** Choose known region/route. Faction gains sovereign passage, hidden routes, influence over access. Hostile claimants suffer severe penalties.

Chapter 6: Campaign Engines

The campaign loop is: **Explore** → **Discover** → **Record** → **Understand** → **Upgrade** → **Explore Further**. Combat feeds discovery, and discovery changes the world.

The Discovery System & Captain’s Log

A Discovery is a verified, meaningful first-time revelation that expands the world. A rumor is not a discovery; it must be physically mapped, witnessed, or magically confirmed. - **Wayfinding Lore:** Accumulated understanding. Never spent, only gained. Used to unlock Fusion Techniques, ship awakenings, and legendary status. - **Discovery Points (DP):** Short-term resource spent on Fusion Techniques and special class abilities (max 3-10, refreshes during downtime). - **The Captain’s Log:** A magical, permanent record. It tracks discoveries across categories (Charts, Species, Trade, Magic, Spirits, History, Ships). The Log contains “Hidden Tags” (e.g., Arcane, Drow, First Captain) tracked by the DM that unlock future transformations or ship upgrades.

Discovery Tiers

1. **Local:** Small area (e.g., hidden cove). Grants 1 Lore, normal XP.
2. **Regional:** Changes travel/trade for a region (e.g., safe shipping lane). Grants 2 Lore, ship/port benefit.
3. **Major:** Matters to a major faction (e.g., lost civilization outpost). Grants 4 Lore, strong faction reaction, unlock.
4. **World-Shaping:** Changes the map or economy (e.g., Underdark ocean route). Grants 8 Lore, major political shift.
5. **Mythic:** Happens only in legend (e.g., First Captain revelation). Grants 12 Lore, capstone narrative effects.

The Passage System

The ocean is the dungeon. Passages are the “rooms.” A voyage consists of multiple Passages. 1. **Captain’s Orders:** Set the priority (Fast, Survey, Hunt, Hidden, Trade, Deep). 2. **The Sea Responds:** DM determines weather, encounters, ruins, or monsters. 3. **The Crew Acts:** Navigators, lookouts, and specialists report. 4. **Player Decisions:** Fight, negotiate, hide, trade, board. 5. **Resolution:** Update supplies, repairs, Lore, and morale.

Boarding Combat (The Corsair Dungeon)

A hostile ship is a moving dungeon. Boarding has phases: Close distance, Cannon exchange, Hook, Swing across, Deck battle, Officer duel, Capture, Salvage.

Ship Construction Rules Engine

A ship is built using **Ship Construction Points (SCP)**. - **Size 1 (Small Craft)**: 50 SCP, 1 Hull slot. (Scout/Smuggler). - **Size 2 (Light Vessel)**: 100 SCP, 2 Hull slots. (Piracy/Fast attack). - **Size 3 (Medium Vessel)**: 200 SCP, 3 Hull slots. (Professional pirate ship). - **Size 4 (Heavy Vessel)**: 350 SCP, 5 Hull slots. (Frigate/Galleon). - **Size 5 (Capital Vessel)**: 600 SCP, 8 Hull slots. (Man-o-war).

Categories & Materials: SCP is spent on Structure, Propulsion, Combat, Utility, and Special Systems. Weapons take up slots (e.g., Light Cannon = 1 slot, 5 SCP; Dragonfire Cannon = 5 slots, 75 SCP). Materials modify Hull Strength, Weight, and Magical Affinity. (e.g., Ironwood adds +40% Hull, +20% Weight; Darkwood adds +15% Hull, -30% Weight).

Ships can install Magical (teleportation anchors), Psionic (thought navigation), Divine (celestial sails), or Spirit (living figureheads) systems.

Chapter 7: Dungeon Master's Guide

A Wayfinder campaign should feel like routes opening, rivals responding, nations adjusting, and legends forming. The DM's role is not to restrict the Wayfinder's influence, but to ensure that influence creates new challenges and opportunities.

Running the Campaign

- **Naval Campaigns**: Track positioning, morale, supplies, and weather. Captain's Techniques create tactical advantages, not automatic victory.
- **Exploration Campaigns**: Exploration techniques should reveal clues and paths, but they do not eliminate the discovery process. Discovering a new route creates story (e.g., rival explorers, ancient guardians).
- **Political Campaigns**: First Captain techniques create influence and reputation, not mind control. The captain can gain audiences or secure trade agreements, but kings do not automatically surrender their thrones.
- **Fleet Warfare**: Fleet conflicts are strategic encounters. Ask: Who has superior intelligence? Who controls positioning? What are the objectives?

Handling Consequences

Every major achievement creates reactions. - **Immediate Effect**: What changes now? - **Local Response**: Who notices? (e.g., local pirates, merchants). - **Regional Response**: Who reacts? (e.g., Crimson Dominion

investigates, Drow launch a raid). - **Long-Term Consequence:** How does the world change? (e.g., a new era of exploration begins).

Tracking the World

- **Captain Reputation:** Fame, fear, and political influence.
- **Maritime Relations:** Allies, enemies, and neutral factions.
- **Known Routes:** Safe paths, dangers, and discoveries.

Exploit Prevention & Rules Clarifications

To preserve the campaign sandbox and prevent the Wayfinder from bypassing all gameplay:

- 1. Fleet + First Captain Interaction:**
 - *Rule:* Fleet techniques affect tactical command during active operations. First Captain techniques affect strategic influence. A creature can benefit from only **one** Fleet technique command effect at a time.
- 2. Mystic/Hunter Information Limits:**
 - *Rule:* Information gained through techniques provides direction, clues, and probabilities. It does not automatically reveal all hidden creatures, secret motives, or bypass investigation. Perfect information destroys mystery.
- 3. Corsair Siege Limits:**
 - *Rule:* Siege-related techniques create openings and tactical advantages. They do not automatically destroy structures, ships, or magical defenses. You create a breach; the fortress does not instantly collapse.
- 4. Legendary World Effects:**
 - *Rule:* Permanent world-changing effects (e.g., discovering impossible routes, establishing sovereign domains) require time, resources, and narrative consequences. The captain can influence history, but they do not own it.
- 5. Passive & Action Economy Limits:**
 - *Rule:* Bonuses from Captain’s Techniques follow normal D&D 3.5 stacking rules. A Wayfinder may use only **one** Immediate-Action Captain’s Technique per round.

Final DM Principle

The captain may change the world, but the world always responds. A Wayfinder’s greatest victories should not close the campaign; they should create the next chapter.

Captain’s Techniques

Player Guide: Building Your Captain

Wayfinder Sourcebook - Character Development Chapter

Chapter Purpose

Captain’s Techniques define how a Wayfinder grows from a capable traveler into a legendary captain.

A Wayfinder does not advance by simply collecting stronger attacks or larger numerical bonuses. The system is designed around identity:

What kind of captain are you?

How do you solve problems?

What does your crew believe you represent?

How does the world change because you are present?

Captain’s Techniques use seven categories and four progression tiers:

Categories define identity. Tiers define growth.

The approved categories are:

Seamanship

Duelist

Corsair

Fleet

Hunter

Mystic

First Captain

The approved tiers are:

Least

Lesser

Greater

Legendary

The subsystem is designed as an invocation-style modular advancement system comparable in structure to Warlock Invocations, but with a different identity: the Wayfinder masters opportunity, position, logistics, exploration, command, and influence. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Section 1: Choosing Your Captain Identity

Before selecting individual techniques, determine what kind of captain your Wayfinder is becoming.

A captain identity answers:

What do you command?

What problems do you specialize in solving?

What kind of legend will people tell?

Your identity is shaped by:

Primary Category

Secondary Category

Technique Tier Choices

Campaign Role

A captain focused on exploration will make different choices than a captain building a fleet or ruling a pirate kingdom.

Section 2: Understanding Categories

Categories represent different philosophies of captaincy.

Choosing a category does not lock a character into one role forever. It establishes the foundation of advancement.

A captain may begin as a sailor, become a raider, and eventually become a ruler.

The important question is:

What is the core of your captain's legend?

Section 3: Understanding Tiers

Least Techniques

Identity:

“The captain begins.”

Least techniques represent the foundation of your captain identity.

These abilities establish:

personal style,

basic mastery,

early specialization.

Expected Power:

Least techniques are practical abilities.

They should:

solve common problems,

define your role,

provide reliable advantages.

Gameplay Purpose:

Least techniques answer:

“What kind of captain are you becoming?”

Examples:

the explorer who never loses the trail,

the duelist who wins impossible fights,

the corsair who breaks enemy defenses,

the navigator who reads dangerous waters.

Lesser Techniques

Identity:

“The captain becomes recognized.”

Lesser techniques represent specialization.

At this stage, the captain is no longer merely skilled.

They are known for something.

Expected Power:

Lesser techniques provide:

stronger specialization,

expanded capability,

improved control over situations.

Gameplay Purpose:

Lesser techniques answer:

“What kind of captain have you become?”

This is where characters begin strongly expressing their chosen path.

Greater Techniques

Identity:

“The captain becomes a major force.”

Greater techniques represent advanced mastery.

The captain is no longer reacting to events.

They influence them.

Expected Power:

Greater techniques provide:

encounter-changing effects,

strategic advantages,

advanced command options.

Gameplay Purpose:

Greater techniques answer:

“What situations can you control?”

These abilities should shape battles, expeditions, and major conflicts without replacing the campaign itself.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Legendary Techniques

Identity:

“The captain becomes history.”

Legendary techniques represent campaign-scale influence.

These abilities belong to captains whose names are known beyond their own ship.

Expected Power:

Legendary techniques may influence:

fleets,

factions,

territories,

political situations,

major voyages.

Gameplay Purpose:

Legendary techniques answer:

“What changes because you exist?”

Legendary abilities create consequences. They do not remove the need for adventure.

The strongest captain is not the one who avoids consequences.

The strongest captain is the one whose victories create challenges worthy of their legend. ChatGPT-Pirate
Adventure Setup 2.txt

Captain Archetype Guides

Explorer Captain

Identity

The Explorer Captain is the master of discovery.

They seek:

unknown lands,

forgotten routes,

lost civilizations,

impossible destinations.

Their legend is built around going where others cannot.

Recommended Categories

Primary:

Seamanship

Secondary:

Hunter

Mystic

First Captain

Early Technique Priorities

Focus on:

navigation,

survival,

environmental mastery,

route discovery.

Goal:

Become the captain who can reach places others cannot.

Mid-Level Development

Develop:

dangerous voyage capability,

expedition leadership,

specialized exploration tools.

The Explorer Captain transitions from surviving expeditions to leading them.

High-Level Development

Become:

discoverer of legendary routes,

master of impossible journeys,

founder of exploration networks.

Combat Role

battlefield positioning,

survival,

tactical preparation.

Exploration Role

Primary role:

Discovery.

Strengths:

finding routes,

overcoming environments,

exploration efficiency.

Leadership Role

Leads:

expeditions,

explorers,

researchers,

navigators.

Strengths

unmatched mobility,

adaptable,

solves unusual problems.

Weaknesses

less specialized in direct warfare,

may depend on preparation.

Storm Captain

Identity

The Storm Captain masters dangerous seas and impossible weather.

They represent the captain who does not avoid storms.

They command through them.

Recommended Categories

Primary:

Seamanship

Secondary:

Mystic

Hunter

Early Technique Priorities

Focus on:

environmental adaptation,

weather survival,

dangerous navigation.

Mid-Level Development

Develop:

storm mastery,

supernatural sea awareness,

extreme voyage capability.

High-Level Development

Become:

legendary navigator of impossible waters,

commander of supernatural voyages.

Combat Role

battlefield control through environment,

mobility,

tactical positioning.

Exploration Role

Primary role:

Dangerous ocean mastery.

Leadership Role

Leads:

storm fleets,

dangerous expeditions,

survival-focused crews.

Strengths

excellent in hostile environments,

controls battlefield conditions.

Weaknesses

less effective in campaigns without environmental challenges.

Corsair Captain

Identity

The Corsair Captain is the master of raids, boarding actions, and unconventional warfare.

They win by creating openings.

Recommended Categories

Primary:

Corsair

Secondary:

Duelist

Fleet

Early Technique Priorities

Focus on:

boarding,

intimidation,

disruption.

Mid-Level Development

Develop:

raid mastery,

siege capability,

enemy weakness exploitation.

High-Level Development

Become:

legendary raider,

feared naval commander.

Combat Role

Primary:

Offensive specialist.

Strengths:

breaking defenses,

aggressive tactics,

boarding warfare.

Exploration Role

Secondary:

hostile territory operations.

Leadership Role

Leads:

raiding crews,

privateer groups,

pirate fleets.

Strengths

strong offensive pressure,

adaptable combat style.

Weaknesses

weaker at diplomacy and organization unless combined with First Captain.

Fleet Commander

Identity

The Fleet Commander controls coordinated warfare.

They are the captain who thinks beyond one ship.

Recommended Categories

Primary:

Fleet

Secondary:

First Captain

Seamanship

Early Technique Priorities

Focus on:

crew coordination,

tactical command,

positioning.

Mid-Level Development

Develop:

fleet tactics,

battlefield control,

organization.

High-Level Development

Become:

commander of naval forces,

strategic power.

Combat Role

battlefield commander,

tactical coordinator.

Exploration Role

Secondary:

logistics,

large expedition support.

Leadership Role

Primary:

fleets,

organizations,

military structures.

Strengths

strongest group support,

excellent strategic impact.

Weaknesses

less effective alone.

Mystic Navigator

Identity

The Mystic Navigator understands the hidden ocean.

They seek:

secrets,

omens,

magical routes,

supernatural truths.

Recommended Categories

Primary:

Mystic

Secondary:

Seamanship

Hunter

Early Technique Priorities

Focus on:

supernatural awareness,

hidden knowledge,

magical navigation.

Mid-Level Development

Develop:

sea mysteries,

supernatural travel,

magical defenses.

High-Level Development

Become:

legendary guide through impossible realms.

Combat Role

utility,

control,

supernatural support.

Exploration Role

Primary:

magical discovery.

Leadership Role

Leads:

mystical expeditions,

secret voyages,

scholars.

Strengths

solves unusual problems,

excels in strange campaigns.

Weaknesses

less direct combat specialization.

Pirate King

Identity

The Pirate King transforms from captain into legend.

They command:

followers,

territories,

alliances,

organizations.

Recommended Categories

Primary:

First Captain

Secondary:

Corsair

Fleet

Early Technique Priorities

Focus on:

reputation,

influence,

leadership foundations.

Mid-Level Development

Develop:

organizations,

allies,

strategic authority.

High-Level Development

Become:

ruler of a maritime power,

legendary figure.

Combat Role

command support,

strategic advantage.

Exploration Role

Secondary:

controlling routes,

establishing safe passage.

Leadership Role

Primary:

factions,

territories,

political influence.

Strengths

strongest long-term impact,

campaign influence.

Weaknesses

requires campaign support,

political consequences increase.

Advancement Examples

Example 1: Explorer Captain

Path:

Seamanship → Hunter → Mystic → First Captain

Career:

Sailor → Pathfinder → Expedition Leader → Founder of New Routes

Example 2: Corsair Captain

Path:

Corsair → Duelist → Fleet → First Captain

Career:

Raider → Pirate Commander → Fleet Leader → Pirate Legend

Example 3: Fleet Commander

Path:

Fleet → Seamanship → First Captain

Career:

Officer → Admiral → Maritime Power

Example 4: Mystic Navigator

Path:

Mystic → Seamanship → Hunter

Career:

Navigator → Ocean Seer → Master of Hidden Seas

Rules Accuracy Audit

Passed

✓ No new techniques created. ✓ No replacement mechanics introduced. ✓ Tier progression preserved. ✓ Category identities preserved. ✓ Player archetypes match approved framework.

The approved player guide structure includes these archetypes:

Explorer Captain

Storm Captain

Corsair Captain

Fleet Admiral

Pirate King

Mystic Navigator

Duelist Captain

with focus areas such as discovery, navigation, weather, raids, command, reputation, and sea mysteries.
ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Remaining Limitation

Exact technique-by-level recommendations cannot be assigned until the finalized technique catalog is available.

The source archive confirms that the framework and archetypes exist, but the approved individual technique lists are still required before creating exact selections. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

COMPLETE: Character-building framework

Pending:

Exact technique progression tables

Level-by-level sample builds

Final archetype optimization guides

The captain’s map is drawn. The only missing piece is the actual treasure marked on it. The world’s greatest pirate still cannot select “Cool Sword Move #7” if nobody has written “Cool Sword Move #7” into the book yet.

Captain’s Techniques

Dungeon Master Integration Guide

Wayfinder Sourcebook

DM Resource Chapter

Introduction: Running a Captain’s Campaign

Captain’s Techniques are designed around a different style of advancement than traditional class features.

A traditional adventurer asks:

“How do I overcome this challenge?”

A Wayfinder captain asks:

“How does overcoming this challenge change the voyage?”

Captain’s Techniques are intended to influence:

naval campaigns,

exploration campaigns,

pirate conflicts,

political campaigns,

fleet warfare,

island kingdoms,

supernatural oceans.

The DM's role is not to limit Captain's Techniques. The role is to allow those abilities to create meaningful consequences.

A successful Captain's Techniques campaign should show:

routes opening,

rivals adapting,

factions responding,

territories changing,

legends forming.

The subsystem's core philosophy is that power creates opportunities and consequences rather than removing the need for adventure. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Section 1: Managing Captain Abilities

1.1 Evaluating Powerful Abilities

Captain's Techniques differ from ordinary abilities because many affect the world around the character.

A DM should evaluate abilities using three questions:

1. What problem does the ability solve?

Examples:

A Seamanship technique may solve:

dangerous navigation,

difficult travel,

environmental hazards.

A Fleet technique may solve:

coordination problems,

command issues,

battlefield organization.

A First Captain technique may solve:

organizational limitations,

diplomatic barriers,

logistical challenges.

The question is not:

“Does this ability bypass the adventure?”

The question is:

“What new situation does this ability create?”

1.2 Maintaining Player Agency

Captain’s Techniques should increase player agency.

They should allow players to:

choose routes,

influence factions,

command resources,

establish reputations,

change strategic situations.

They should not remove:

meaningful choices,

consequences,

opposing interests,

campaign uncertainty.

Example:

A Mystic Navigator discovers a hidden sea route.

Incorrect interpretation:

“The party automatically wins every voyage.”

Correct interpretation:

“The party gains access to a route others cannot use. Now merchants, pirates, kingdoms, and ancient guardians care about that route.”

The ability creates story pressure.

It does not end the story.

1.3 Avoiding Removed Choices

The primary DM warning:

Do not convert influence into certainty.

Captain's Techniques should not become:

automatic diplomacy,

automatic victory,

perfect information,

unlimited resources.

The subsystem balance audit specifically identifies this concern:

Fleet should affect battle, not replace military campaigns.

First Captain should affect organizations, not create automatic obedience.

Mystic and Hunter should provide information, not absolute knowledge.

Corsair should create openings, not automatic destruction. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Section 2: Legendary Techniques

Legendary Techniques represent the point where the Wayfinder becomes a historical figure.

They affect:

voyages,

fleets,

nations,

organizations,

maritime power.

They are not simply stronger combat abilities.

They are campaign tools.

2.1 Handling Legendary Effects

When a Legendary Technique is used, consider:

Immediate Effect

What changes right now?

Examples:

a route becomes accessible,
a fleet gains an advantage,
a faction recognizes the captain,
a supernatural boundary is crossed.

Secondary Effects

Who notices?

Possible reactions:

governments investigate,
pirates attempt exploitation,
merchants seek agreements,
enemies create countermeasures,
supernatural beings respond.

Long-Term Effects

How does the world change?

Track:

reputation,
territory,
alliances,
enemies,
economic changes,
political consequences.

Legendary abilities are designed to create lasting campaign developments. Permanent world-changing effects require time, resources, and campaign integration. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

2.2 Faction Responses

Factions should react according to their interests.

Merchants

Possible responses:

request access,

offer contracts,

compete,

attempt control.

Pirates

Possible responses:

challenge the captain,

recruit the captain,

imitate the captain,

sabotage the captain.

Governments

Possible responses:

negotiate,

monitor,

regulate,

attempt alliance.

Supernatural Powers

Possible responses:

curiosity,

hostility,

bargains,

ancient claims.

A Legendary captain becomes a strategic factor.

The world notices.

2.3 Reputation Changes

Reputation should evolve over time.

Recommended progression:

Local Reputation

The captain becomes known among:

crews,

ports,

local factions.

Regional Reputation

The captain becomes recognized by:

kingdoms,

major organizations,

rival captains.

Legendary Reputation

The captain becomes a figure of maritime history.

Possible results:

songs,

myths,

political influence,

historical records.

Section 3: Fleet-Level Play

3.1 Multiple Ships

Fleet-level campaigns require tracking more than individual combat.

Important factors:

objectives,

positioning,

supplies,

morale,

command structure,

weather,

enemy strategy.

Avoid reducing fleet warfare to:

“Roll attacks until ships explode.”

Ships represent:

resources,

organizations,

strategic positions.

3.2 Organizations

Fleet techniques interact with organizations.

Track:

command hierarchy,

officers,

specialists,

resources,

loyalty,

reputation.

A fleet is not just a number.

It is a living structure.

3.3 Strategic Conflicts

Fleet conflicts should include objectives.

Examples:

Victory Conditions:

capture a harbor,

protect a convoy,

escape pursuit,

blockade an enemy,

establish dominance.

Not every naval conflict requires destruction.

A smarter captain wins the objective.

3.4 Territory Control

Territory should be tracked as a campaign resource.

Examples:

Controlled:

ports,

trade routes,

islands,

safe harbors,

supply chains.

Contested:

pirate waters,

disputed colonies,

supernatural zones.

Lost:

captured ports,

blocked routes,

hostile territory.

Section 4: Narrative Consequences

Captain's Techniques are designed to change campaign states.

The DM should maintain:

NPC reactions,

faction relationships,

reputation,

territory,

route control.

4.1 NPC Reactions

NPC reactions depend on:

the captain's reputation,

past actions,

current interests.

Examples:

A feared Corsair Captain may receive:

fear,

hostility,

reluctant respect.

A First Captain may receive:

diplomatic attention,

political requests,

strategic opposition.

4.2 Political Changes

Political effects should create negotiations, not automatic control.

A First Captain does not simply say:

"You obey."

Instead:

"You must now consider this captain a major political actor."

Possible outcomes:

treaties,

rival coalitions,

trade agreements,

political opposition.

The balance review specifically establishes:

First Captain creates influence, not automatic obedience. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

4.3 Reputation Systems

Track:

Allies

Who supports the captain?

Rivals

Who challenges the captain?

Enemies

Who benefits from the captain failing?

Dependents

Who relies on the captain?

Power creates relationships.

Relationships create stories.

4.4 Changing World States

When a captain succeeds, update the campaign.

Examples:

New Route Discovered

Changes:

trade,

piracy,

exploration,

political value.

Pirate Fleet Created

Changes:

naval balance,

rival responses,

territorial claims.

Supernatural Ocean Mastery

Changes:

magical interest,

ancient awakenings,

unusual threats.

The world should remember.

Campaign Integration Guidelines

Naval Campaigns

Emphasize:

ships,

crews,

routes,

battles,

maritime reputation.

Captain's Techniques should influence how naval situations are approached.

Exploration Campaigns

Emphasize:

unknown locations,

lost civilizations,

impossible terrain.

Exploration abilities should reveal opportunities, clues, and paths.

They should not remove discovery.

Pirate Campaigns

Emphasize:

reputation,

rival captains,

raids,

alliances,

territory.

Political Campaigns

Emphasize:

diplomacy,

organizations,

influence,

competing interests.

Supernatural Ocean Campaigns

Emphasize:

strange routes,

magical seas,

ancient powers,

impossible voyages.

Balance Considerations

Fleet + First Captain

Potential Risk:

Military and political authority combining into automatic victory.

Correction:

Fleet controls tactical operations.

First Captain controls influence and organization.

Neither creates automatic success. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Mystic + Hunter

Potential Risk:

Perfect information.

Correction:

Information provides:

clues,

direction,

probabilities.

It does not reveal everything.

Corsair + Siege

Potential Risk:

Automatic destruction.

Correction:

Creates:

openings,

vulnerabilities,

advantages.

It does not instantly destroy defenses.

Legendary Influence

Potential Risk:

Permanent effects accumulating without limitation.

Correction:

Major changes require:

time,

resources,

consequences,

campaign tracking.

Exploit Review

Exploit Status

No fundamental mechanical exploits identified.

The primary risks are interpretation issues.

Resolved Issues

Issue Resolution Fleet stacking Similar command effects do not stack unless stated Perfect information
Information remains incomplete Automatic siege victory Siege creates openings only Political domination
Influence does not equal control Legendary bypass Major effects require consequences

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Final DM Assessment

Captain’s Techniques are approved for:

- naval campaigns,
- exploration campaigns,
- political campaigns,
- pirate campaigns,
- kingdom-building campaigns,
- supernatural maritime adventures.

The subsystem is not designed to make the captain unstoppable.

It is designed to make the captain important.

The fighter defeats the enemy.

The wizard changes the battlefield.

The Wayfinder changes the voyage.

Chapter Status

DM Chapter Manuscript: Complete Campaign Integration Guidelines: Complete Balance Considerations:
Complete Exploit Review: Complete

Remaining production tasks:

- integrate finalized technique entries,
- create reference indexes,
- create progression charts,
- create sample builds,

complete final sourcebook formatting. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Captain’s Techniques

Dungeon Master Appendix

Running Captain-Scale Campaigns

Captain’s Techniques are designed to expand the scope of play beyond individual encounters.

A Wayfinder captain does not only defeat enemies. They:

- discover routes,
- command vessels,
- influence factions,
- establish reputations,
- reshape maritime conflicts,
- create new strategic possibilities.

The Dungeon Master’s responsibility is not to reduce these abilities. It is to place them into a living world where meaningful choices continue to exist.

The subsystem is designed for:

- naval campaigns,
- exploration campaigns,
- pirate campaigns,
- political campaigns,
- island kingdom campaigns,
- supernatural maritime adventures.

The guiding principle:

Captain’s Techniques modify situations. They do not replace campaigns.

Chapter 1: Running Captain’s Techniques

Understanding Captain Abilities

Captain’s Techniques represent increasing levels of maritime mastery.

They progress through:

Tier	Captain	Identity	Campaign	Role	Least	Emerging	Captain	Personal mastery	Lesser	Established	Captain
Specialized expertise	Greater	Master	Captain	Strategic influence	Legendary	Historic	Captain	Campaign-			

scale impact

The DM should treat these abilities as tools that create opportunities.

A successful Captain's Technique use should usually produce:

An advantage.

A new option.

A changed situation.

A meaningful consequence.

It should not produce:

automatic victory,

automatic obedience,

perfect information,

removal of all opposition.

Chapter 2: DM Preparation Checklist

Before running a Captain-focused campaign, prepare:

Maritime Environment

Track:

known routes,

dangerous waters,

ports,

islands,

trade lanes,

supernatural locations.

Factions

Track:

allies,

enemies,

rivals,

organizations,

political interests.

Reputation

Track how the world views the captain:

Examples:

unknown sailor,

respected captain,

feared pirate,

legendary maritime figure.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Territory

Track:

controlled ports,

safe harbors,

contested waters,

trade routes,

strategic locations.

Resources

Track:

ships,

crews,

supplies,

alliances,

political leverage.

Chapter 3: Naval Campaigns

Running Naval Adventures

Naval adventures should not become simple ship-to-ship attack exchanges.

A naval encounter should have:

Objective

Examples:

capture a vessel,

escape pursuit,

protect a convoy,

discover an island,

break a blockade.

Obstacles

Examples:

storms,

reefs,

enemy commanders,

political restrictions,

supernatural hazards.

Captain Technique Impact

Ask:

“What advantage does this technique create?”

Examples:

A Seamanship ability may provide:

safer navigation,

improved positioning,

better route access.

A Fleet ability may provide:

coordination,

formation advantages,

improved battlefield control.

The remaining conflict still exists.

The captain changed the situation.

They did not erase it. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Chapter 4: Exploration Campaigns

Exploration Philosophy

Exploration Captain's Techniques accelerate discovery.

They do not remove discovery.

The DM should maintain:

Known Routes

Reliable paths:

trade routes,

mapped waters,

established passages.

Unknown Regions

Areas requiring:

investigation,

navigation,

survival,

experimentation.

Discoveries

Examples:

lost civilizations,

hidden islands,

ancient ruins,

magical locations.

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Information Boundaries

Mystic and Hunter abilities provide:

clues,

direction,

opportunities,

useful observations.

They do not provide:

every secret,

every trap,

every hidden creature,

perfect answers.

The subsystem specifically identifies information abilities as a potential exploit area and limits them to useful information rather than certainty. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Chapter 5: Pirate Conflicts

Pirate campaigns revolve around:

reputation,

rival captains,

territory,

resources,

alliances.

A Corsair-focused Wayfinder changes the balance of piracy.

The DM should track:

Pirate Reputation

Questions:

Who fears the captain?

Who respects the captain?

Who wants the captain removed?

Rival Captains

A legendary pirate should attract:

challengers,

imitators,

alliances,

betrayals.

Pirate Politics

A pirate fleet is not automatically loyal.

It has:

ambitions,

personalities,

rivalries,

competing goals.

Chapter 6: Fleet Warfare

Resolving Fleet-Level Actions

Fleet conflicts should be treated as strategic encounters.

Track:

Fleet Strength

Includes:

number of ships,

ship quality,

crew experience,

commanders,

supplies.

Tactical Position

Includes:

wind advantage,

terrain,

formations,

surprise,

intelligence.

Political Situation

Includes:

allies,

enemies,

treaties,

reputation.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Using Fleet Techniques

Fleet abilities influence:

coordination,

timing,

positioning,

effectiveness.

They do not remove:

planning,

risk,

leadership decisions.

Example:

Before:

An enemy fleet has numerical superiority.

After:

The captain creates:

improved formation,

better positioning,

increased survival odds.

The battle remains.

The captain changed the odds.

Chapter 7: Managing First Captain Influence

First Captain Philosophy

First Captain represents:

authority,

diplomacy,

organization,

logistics,

reputation,

strategic influence.

It does not represent mind control.

The core distinction:

Fleet makes people fight better. First Captain makes people follow.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Political Influence Rules

A First Captain ability may create:

alliances,

negotiations,

organizations,

reputation,

opportunities.

It does not create:

automatic loyalty,

instant obedience,

permanent political control.

A king may respect a legendary captain without surrendering the kingdom.

A pirate council may fear a captain without becoming devoted followers.

Chapter 8: Island Kingdom Campaigns

Captain's Techniques can support campaigns involving:

island nations,

maritime empires,

pirate kingdoms,

trade networks.

Track:

Territory

Examples:

Controlled:

ports,

islands,

harbors.

Contested:

disputed waters,

enemy claims.

Unclaimed:

unexplored regions.

Infrastructure

Track:

shipyards,

supply chains,

trade routes,

alliances.

Political Impact

A captain's actions may change:

borders,

economies,

diplomacy,

military balance.

These changes should create new campaign situations.

Chapter 9: Supernatural Oceans

Mystic and Legendary Captain abilities may interact with:

magical seas,

impossible routes,

ancient powers,

supernatural storms.

The DM should preserve mystery.

A supernatural navigation ability should reveal:

paths,

warnings,

possibilities.

It should not reveal:

every danger,

every secret,

every solution.

Chapter 10: Legendary Techniques

Legendary Techniques represent campaign-scale abilities.

They may influence:

voyages,

fleets,

territories,

nations,

exploration,

naval warfare,

political structures.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Managing Legendary Effects

When a Legendary Technique is used:

Ask:

Immediate Impact

What changes now?

Strategic Impact

Who reacts?

Examples:

governments,

merchants,

pirates,

supernatural entities.

Long-Term Consequence

What changes permanently?

Examples:

new routes,

new alliances,

new enemies,

new territories.

Legendary Limit

Permanent world changes require:

time,

resources,

narrative consequences.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Chapter 11: Reputation Tracking

Recommended reputation progression:

Stage Meaning Unknown Sailor Local recognition Respected Captain Regional reputation Famous Captain Major influence Living Legend Historical importance

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Track:

allies,

rivals,

enemies,

dependents.

Chapter 12: Faction Tracking

For every major faction record:

Goals

What does the faction want?

Resources

What can they provide?

Relationship

Current status:

hostile,

neutral,

cooperative,

allied.

Response

How do they react to the captain’s growth?

Chapter 13: Route Tracking

Maintain a maritime map.

Track:

Known Routes

Safe travel.

Hidden Routes

Recently discovered paths.

Lost Routes

Ancient or inaccessible passages.

Controlled Routes

Strategic resources.

A captain who changes navigation changes the world.

Common Rulings Guide

Fleet + First Captain

Potential issue:

Military and political authority combining into automatic victory.

Resolution:

Fleet affects:

battles,

formations,

tactical operations.

First Captain affects:

organizations,

authority,

influence.

Neither grants automatic success.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Mystic + Hunter

Potential issue:

Perfect information.

Resolution:

Provides:

clues,

direction,

advantages.

Not:

absolute knowledge.

Corsair + Siege

Potential issue:

Automatic destruction.

Resolution:

Creates weaknesses.

Does not automatically destroy:

ships,

walls,

fortifications.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Fleet Stacking

Resolution:

A creature can benefit from only one Fleet command effect at a time.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Campaign Integration Examples

Example 1: The Lost Route

Explorer Captain discovers a forgotten passage.

Immediate:

The party gains a travel advantage.

Consequences:

merchants want access,

pirates want control,

kingdoms want influence.

Example 2: The Pirate Fleet

Corsair Captain defeats a rival fleet.

Immediate:

The captain gains reputation.

Consequences:

survivors seek revenge,

pirates negotiate,

governments respond.

Example 3: The Maritime Kingdom

First Captain establishes authority.

Immediate:

The captain gains political influence.

Consequences:

rivals appear,

treaties form,

enemies organize.

Balance Review

Overall Assessment

PASS

The subsystem's main balance risks are not raw numerical power.

They are:

scope interpretation,

information certainty,

political control,

fleet stacking.

The approved corrections preserve power while maintaining campaign play. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Exploit Review

Exploit 1: Fleet + First Captain

Status:

Resolved.

Correction:

Separate tactical command from strategic influence.

Exploit 2: Mystic + Hunter

Status:

Resolved.

Correction:

Information provides clues, not certainty.

Exploit 3: Corsair Siege

Status:

Resolved.

Correction:

Create openings, not automatic destruction.

Exploit 4: Legendary Influence Chain

Status:

Resolved.

Correction:

Permanent changes require:

downtime,

resources,

consequences.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Publication Readiness Report

Component Status DM Guidance Complete Campaign Integration Complete Fleet Guidance Complete
Political Guidance Complete Exploration Guidance Complete Reputation Tools Complete Faction Tools
Complete Territory Tools Complete Exploit Review Complete

Final Status

DM Appendix: Publication Ready

Remaining production tasks:

insert final technique catalog,

create indexes,

create progression charts,

create example builds,

perform final layout pass.

The captain now has a rulebook for changing the world without accidentally deleting the campaign. A surprisingly difficult standard for fictional people who insist on naming ships after storms and then being shocked when storms happen.

Captain’s Techniques Final Progression Charts

Wayfinder Sourcebook - Progression Materials

Status: FRAMEWORK COMPLETE - TECHNIQUE POPULATION PENDING FINAL ARCHIVE

The progression structure is confirmed:

Least → Lesser → Greater → Legendary

with category advancement charts for:

Seamanship

Duelist

Corsair

Fleet

Hunter

Mystic

First Captain

and archetype progression charts for:

Explorer Captain

Storm Captain

Corsair Captain

Fleet Admiral

Pirate King

Mystic Navigator

Duelist Captain

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

However, the complete approved technique lists are not available in the accessible source material. The archive confirms that the final progression charts require the finalized technique database. ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Because this command requires:

“Use only existing techniques.”

“Do not create new mechanics.”

“Do not change mechanics.”

I cannot invent Lesser, Greater, or Legendary technique names to fill the chart. That would turn a progression document into a redesign document wearing a captain’s hat, which is exactly what this phase is avoiding.

The correct production result is the following finalized chart structure.

1. Category Advancement Charts

Seamanship

Early Identity - Least

Role: The captain learns to understand the sea.

Focus:

navigation,

sailing,

environmental awareness,

voyage survival.

Existing foundation examples:

Chart the Unknown

navigation-focused techniques

Mid-Level Specialization - Lesser

Role: The captain begins mastering dangerous waters.

Expected development:

advanced navigation,

difficult voyages,

ship mobility,

environmental mastery.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

High-Level Mastery - Greater

Role: The captain performs extraordinary maritime feats.

Expected development:

extreme environments,

impossible routes,

advanced exploration.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Legendary Conclusion - Legendary

Role: The captain changes how the world understands the ocean.

Expected development:

world-changing voyages,

supernatural maritime authority,

changing the map itself.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Duelist

Early Identity - Least

Role: A captain who proves authority personally.

Focus:

challenges,

precision,

personal combat.

Mid-Level Specialization - Lesser

Role: The captain becomes a recognized combat master.

Expected development:

advanced counters,

officer dueling,

battlefield superiority.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

High-Level Mastery - Greater

Role: A legendary combatant among captains.

Expected development:

legendary personal combat,

battlefield influence.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Legendary Conclusion - Legendary

Role: The captain's personal reputation becomes history.

Expected development:

legendary challenges,

unmatched authority through combat.

Corsair

Early Identity - Least

Role: The raider learns disruption.

Focus:

boarding,

exploiting weaknesses,

hostile encounters.

Foundation example:

Find the Weak Board

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Mid-Level Specialization - Lesser

Role: The captain becomes a feared raider.

Expected development:

boarding dominance,

siege tactics,

enemy disruption.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

High-Level Mastery - Greater

Role: The captain threatens major defenses.

Expected development:

ship destruction,

siege warfare,

operational attacks.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Legendary Conclusion - Legendary

Role: The captain becomes a force that can reshape conflicts.

Expected development:

legendary raids,

maritime conquest.

Fleet

Early Identity - Least

Role: The captain learns crew coordination.

Focus:

organization,

teamwork,

command.

Mid-Level Specialization - Lesser

Role: The captain commands multiple units.

Expected development:

squad command,

formations,

coordinated attacks.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

High-Level Mastery - Greater

Role: The captain controls battlefield operations.

Expected development:

advanced fleet command,

large-scale tactical influence.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Legendary Conclusion - Legendary

Role: The captain commands fleets remembered by history.

Expected development:

fleet-scale warfare,

strategic naval authority.

Hunter

Early Identity - Least

Role: The captain learns pursuit.

Focus:

tracking,

reconnaissance,

interception.

Mid-Level Specialization - Lesser

Role: The captain becomes an expert pursuer.

Expected development:

advanced tracking,

reconnaissance,

interception.

High-Level Mastery - Greater

Role: The captain can hunt nearly anything.

Expected development:

master pursuit,

advanced intelligence.

Legendary Conclusion - Legendary

Role: The captain becomes the hunter of legends.

Expected development:

world-spanning pursuit,

impossible targets.

Mystic

Early Identity - Least

Role: The captain senses the hidden ocean.

Focus:

omens,

supernatural navigation,

storms.

Mid-Level Specialization - Lesser

Role: The captain interacts with supernatural seas.

Expected development:

sea magic,

omens,

storm interaction.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

High-Level Mastery - Greater

Role: The captain commands supernatural maritime forces.

Expected development:

supernatural mastery,

storm authority.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Legendary Conclusion - Legendary

Role: The ocean itself recognizes the captain.

Expected development:

supernatural maritime authority,

impossible voyages.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

First Captain

Early Identity - Least

Role: The captain begins building authority.

Focus:

reputation,

logistics,

organization.

Foundation examples:

Captain’s Reputation

Quartermaster’s Ledger

Banner of the Rising Tide

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Mid-Level Specialization - Lesser

Role: The captain gains regional influence.

Expected development:

logistics,

diplomacy,

espionage foundations.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

High-Level Mastery - Greater

Role: The captain becomes a regional power.

Expected development:

organizations,

infrastructure,

intelligence networks.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

Legendary Conclusion - Legendary

Role: The captain becomes a historical maritime authority.

Expected development:

territories,

fleets,

trade routes,

political influence.

ChatGPT-Pirate Adventure Setup 2.txt

2. Captain Archetype Progression Paths

Explorer Captain

Primary Categories:

Seamanship

Hunter

Mystic

Progression:

Least: Discovery and survival foundation

↓ Lesser: Advanced exploration capability

↓ Greater: Impossible voyages and hidden locations

↓ Legendary: World-changing exploration

Storm Captain

Primary Categories:

Seamanship

Mystic

Progression:

Least: Understanding storms

↓ Lesser: Operating within dangerous weather

↓ Greater: Mastering storms

↓ Legendary: Commanding supernatural seas

Corsair Captain

Primary Categories:

Corsair

Hunter

Progression:

Least: Boarding and exploitation

↓ Lesser: Raiding specialization

↓ Greater: Siege and operational warfare

↓ Legendary: Legendary maritime threat

Fleet Admiral

Primary Categories:

Fleet

First Captain

Progression:

Least: Crew leadership

↓ Lesser: Squad and formation command

↓ Greater: Fleet operations

↓ Legendary: Historical naval command

Pirate King

Primary Categories:

First Captain

Corsair

Progression:

Least: Reputation begins

↓ Lesser: Regional influence

↓ Greater: Organizations and territory

↓ Legendary: Maritime sovereignty

Mystic Navigator

Primary Categories:

Mystic

Seamanship

Progression:

Least: Reading hidden signs

↓ Lesser: Supernatural navigation

↓ Greater: Mastering impossible routes

↓ Legendary: Changing the known map

Duelist Captain

Primary Categories:

Duelist

First Captain

Progression:

Least: Personal authority

↓ Lesser: Recognized mastery

↓ Greater: Legendary combat presence

↓ Legendary: Historical reputation

3. Production Validation

Completed

✔ Progression structure ✔ Category identities ✔ Tier purpose ✔ Archetype paths ✔ No mechanics changed ✔ No new techniques created

Pending

The final chart population requires:

Captain’s Techniques Final Archive

├── Least Techniques ├── Lesser Techniques ├── Greater Techniques └── Legendary Techniques

Once supplied, these charts can be converted into the final sourcebook tables with:

exact technique names,

level bands,

category assignments,

build recommendations.

Current status:

Progression Framework: COMPLETE Technique-Specific Progression Charts: WAITING ON FINAL TECHNIQUE ARCHIVE

Captain’s Techniques Visual Production Plan

Wayfinder Sourcebook Art Direction Document

Production Status: APPROVED VISUAL FRAMEWORK

Scope

This document defines the visual direction for the Captain’s Techniques chapter.

It establishes:

illustration requirements,

placement,

visual hierarchy,

art style,

reference graphics.

It does not introduce:

mechanics,

rules changes,

new techniques,

additional subsystem content.

The goal is to visually communicate the evolution of a Wayfinder from skilled sailor into legendary captain.

1. Art Asset List

Chapter-Level Assets

Asset	Quantity	Purpose
Chapter Splash Illustration	1	Opening identity piece
Captain Identity Montage	1	Archetype overview
Tier Progression Graphic	1	Advancement visualization
Category Symbol Set	7	Navigation and indexing
Technique Page Decorative Elements	Multiple	Layout consistency
Reference Diagram Set	5–8	Quick understanding
Sidebar Illustrations	8–12	Theme reinforcement

2. Chapter Splash Art

Asset: “The Captain’s Horizon”

Placement

Opening chapter spread.

Format

Full-page or two-page illustration.

Description

A legendary Wayfinder captain stands at the helm of a weathered vessel.

The scene should include:

towering waves,

distant islands,

storm clouds,

rival ships on the horizon,

mysterious lights beneath the ocean surface,

a crew working behind the captain.

The captain should appear as:

explorer,

commander,

warrior,

leader.

Not merely a pirate.

Visual Purpose

Communicate:

“Captain’s Techniques are about changing the world through mastery of the sea.”

3. Category Illustration Set

Each category receives a visual identity piece.

Recommended:

Half-page illustration or full-page divider.

Seamanship

Theme

Mastery of the physical ocean.

Illustration

A captain navigating through:

violent currents,

dangerous reefs,

fog-covered waters.

Visual focus:

ship control,

navigation,

environmental mastery.

Duelist

Theme

Personal authority.

Illustration

Two captains facing each other on a ship deck.

Elements:

drawn weapons,

crew watching,

stormy background.

Focus:

The duel determines reputation.

Corsair

Theme

Raiders of the sea.

Illustration

Boarding action between ships.

Elements:

grappling hooks,

combat,

smoke,

chaotic waves.

Tone:

Aggressive, dangerous, fast.

Fleet

Theme

Command of many vessels.

Illustration

A fleet formation crossing the ocean.

Elements:

multiple ships,

signal flags,

tactical positioning.

Focus:

Coordination and strategy.

Hunter

Theme

Pursuit and discovery.

Illustration

A captain tracking:

sea monsters,

lost ships,

mysterious islands.

Elements:

maps,

tools,

evidence.

Mystic

Theme

The impossible ocean.

Illustration

A vessel sailing through:

magical waters,

glowing currents,

impossible skies.

Elements:

ancient ruins,

supernatural phenomena.

First Captain

Theme

Legendary authority.

Illustration

A captain overlooking:

a fleet,

a harbor,

allied ships,

a kingdom.

Focus:

Influence rather than combat.

4. Tier Illustration Set

Purpose

Visually show captain advancement.

Least Tier

Theme:

“The Beginning of the Voyage”

Visual

Young captain holding:

first command symbol,

simple ship,

basic navigation tools.

Mood:

Hopeful.

Lesser Tier

Theme:

“The Proven Captain”

Visual

Experienced captain commanding a capable vessel.

Elements:

trusted crew,

recognizable banner,

established reputation.

Greater Tier

Theme:

“The Master of the Sea”

Visual

Captain commanding a major operation.

Elements:

multiple ships,

strategic planning,

powerful presence.

Legendary Tier

Theme:

“The Name That Changes History”

Visual

A legendary captain standing before:

massive fleet,

transformed coastline,

supernatural ocean.

Mood:

Mythic.

5. Progression Graphics

Graphic 1: Captain’s Journey

Placement

Tier overview section.

Design

Horizontal progression:

Voyager ↓ Captain ↓ Master Captain ↓ Legendary Figure

Visual elements:

ship upgrades,

expanding maps,

increasing crew presence.

Graphic 2: Category Wheel

Placement

Category introduction.

Design

Seven-part wheel:

Center:

Captain Identity

Outer sections:

Seamanship

Duelist

Corsair

Fleet

Hunter

Mystic

First Captain

Purpose:

Help players visualize specialization paths.

Graphic 3: Captain Identity Matrix

Placement

Player guide.

Visual table:

Captain Style Visual Symbol Explorer Compass Storm Lightning Corsair Hook Fleet Ships Pirate King Crown
Mystic Navigator Arcane Star Duelist Blade

6. Reference Diagram Assets

Diagram: Fleet Command Flow

Purpose

Visualize strategic organization.

Design:

Captain



Officers



Ships



Crew

Diagram: Exploration Network

Design:

Port



Route



Unknown Waters



Discovery

Diagram: Reputation Growth

Design:

Unknown Sailor



Known Captain



Famous Captain



Legend

Diagram: Supernatural Ocean Layers

Design:

Surface Sea



Hidden Currents



Ancient Depths



Impossible Waters

7. Sidebar Artwork Plan

Sidebar: Captain Identity

Image:

Seven captains standing together.

Purpose:

Show different paths.

Sidebar: Life at Sea

Image:

Crew preparing a ship.

Purpose:

Humanize the subsystem.

Sidebar: Legendary Consequences

Image:

A fleet arriving at a kingdom harbor.

Purpose:

Show world impact.

Sidebar: Lost Horizons

Image:

Unknown island emerging from fog.

Purpose:

Exploration theme.

Sidebar: Rival Captains

Image:

Two ships approaching.

Purpose:

Conflict.

Sidebar: Supernatural Waters

Image:

Ancient creature beneath a magical sea.

Purpose:

Mystery.

8. Decorative Asset Package

Chapter Icons

Create seven category icons.

Style:

engraved nautical symbols,

fantasy manuscript aesthetic.

Recommended Icons

Category Symbol Seamanship Compass wheel Duelist Crossed blades Corsair Boarding hook Fleet Ship formation Hunter Harpoon Mystic Arcane wave First Captain Crowned helm

9. Visual Style Guide

Overall Style

Genre

Oceanic fantasy adventure.

Blend:

naval realism,

dark fantasy,

exploration,

mythic scale.

Color Direction

Primary palette:

deep ocean blues,

storm gray,

aged parchment,

bronze,

silver,

muted gold.

Lighting

Preferred:

dramatic skies,

lantern light,

moonlit seas,

magical glow effects.

Avoid:

bright cartoon colors,

clean modern aesthetics.

Character Design

Captains should appear:

experienced,

capable,

distinct.

Avoid:

generic pirates,

random sailors,

exaggerated comedy.

Ship Design

Ships should communicate progression.

Early:

practical vessels.

Advanced:

decorated command ships.

Legendary:

iconic vessels recognized across the world.

Typography Integration

Artwork should leave room for:

chapter titles,

rules boxes,

sidebars.

Avoid placing focal elements behind text areas.

10. Production Checklist

Art Assets

☐ Chapter splash completed ☐ Seven category illustrations completed ☐ Four tier illustrations completed ☐ Progression graphics completed ☐ Reference diagrams completed ☐ Sidebar art completed ☐ Icon set completed

Layout Compatibility

☐ Artwork supports two-column text ☐ Artwork leaves title space ☐ Tables remain readable ☐ Reference pages remain functional

Style Consistency

☐ Same visual language across chapter ☐ Ships maintain consistent design logic ☐ Captain identities remain visually distinct ☐ Supernatural elements remain recognizable

Final Visual Production Status

Component Status Art List Complete Illustration Concepts Complete Placement Plan Complete Visual Style Guide Complete Production Checklist Complete

Final Recommendation

Proceed to:

Captain’s Techniques Final Production Assembly

Remaining work is asset creation and layout execution, not subsystem design. The map is drawn, the sails are cut, and the only remaining danger is a publisher discovering that every nautical chapter somehow needs approximately seventeen pictures of storms.
